

Teaching Effectiveness Summary

Mahta Ghafarianghadim | Georgia State University

Student Evaluation of Instructor

	ECON 2106 — Principles of Microeconomics (In Person)	ECON 4220 — Environmental Economics and Policy (Online)	
	Fall 2025	Spring 2026	Summer 2026
Enrollment	112	118	79
Respondents (response rate)	64 (57%)	62 (53%)	26 (33%)
Instructor prepared for class	4.8	4.9	4.9
Instructor communicated effectively	4.5	4.7	4.9
Instructor accessible to students	4.7	4.7	4.9
Instructor explained grading clearly	4.7	4.8	4.9
Environment helped students learn	4.6	4.7	4.9
Course objectives achieved	4.6	4.5	5.0

Selected Student Comments

ECON 2106, Fall 2025

“She was super good at explaining concepts and openly asking about them. Straight-forward, answers questions thoroughly. She always made sure to explain the information necessary on the board.”

“She explained complex ideas step by step, ensuring we understood the principles rather than just memorizing formulas. She also connected the material to real-life examples, making economics relevant and meaningful.”

“The instructor showed genuine concern for student learning by being approachable, fair, and willing to provide additional help when needed.”

ECON 2106, Spring 2026

“The instructor was incredibly organized and followed the syllabus perfectly. Her teaching style made complex microeconomic concepts easy to understand, and the course materials were always prepared and accessible.”

“She created a very supportive learning environment where I felt comfortable asking questions whenever the material became challenging. She was always a good instructor, guiding us through every lesson.”

“I would say that their teaching style has been and will continue to be excellent. I am satisfied, and I am taking away many valuable lessons. Keep doing what you are doing, it's great.”

ECON 4220, Summer 2026

“The instructor always provided clear instructions and expectations for the assignments.”

“She was very clear about the instructions and taught very well.”

“She was overall a great teacher. Loved the class and classmates.”

Full evaluation reports available upon request.

What I Learned from Student Feedback

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I read my evaluations each semester to find where students struggled, not only what they liked. These are the main lessons that have shaped how I teach.

Clear expectations

After my first semester teaching Principles of Microeconomics, student feedback showed that expectations and grading were not always clear. The next semester, I explained grading expectations in detail from the first day and created more chances for questions during class. Course completion rose from 93 to 98 percent, my rating for explaining the grading system rose from 4.7 to 4.8, and my communication rating rose from 4.5 to 4.7.

Online assignments

In Spring 2026, several students said the McGraw Hill Connect activities were long and repetitive. These activities are shared across all sections of the course, so I could not change them. Instead, I looked at the questions students struggled with most and added similar practice questions to my lecture slides, so we worked through them together in class before students met them online.

More active learning

In Fall 2025, some students asked for more hands on activities and fewer slides. I already draw graphs step by step on the board so students can follow the reasoning, and in future courses I plan to add short problems that students work through in pairs during class.

Use of AI tools

In my online course, students could use AI tools to support their learning, but not to write or substantially draft their work. Going forward, I will keep this line and also ask students to briefly explain how they used AI, while assignments ask them to apply course concepts to an issue they choose, in their own words.